CO-FOUNDER SEAT · INTAKE CALL · PRIVATE

Julien van Wyk. *Intake call.* Johannes le Roux.

Music Republik · Section 1 in from 15 Oct · WhatsApp update 21 Oct · Prepared 22 Oct 2026 · About 60 minutes, recording on

01 How to run it

He's struggling to find the time for the form, and most of what it asks he doesn't know. That's not a problem with him. It's the finding: nine revenue lines and nobody holding the numbers is exactly why he needs the seat. Since 19 Oct he has told you he wants to start in November and pay now, so the first five minutes are a close, not a pitch.

- **He talks, you write.** Don't read out field names. Ask the way you would over a coffee.
- **Bracket, don't ask open.** "More like R500k or more like R2m?" He'll know the side even without the number.
- **"Don't know" goes on the list.** That list is the real output. It becomes the first 90 days.
- **One hour, then stop.** If his energy drops, park the rest for the first session.

> OPEN WITH
>
> "Section 1 was the part only you could do, and you did it. Everything else is my job. When you don't know, just say so. That's what we're here to find out."

02 The call

Close the seat NEW 21 OCT — 5 MIN

- [ ] He wrote "kom ons spring in en doen sommer daai betaling vir November." Confirm: **10 hours a month, R20,000, starts 1 November, invoiced in advance.** Send the invoice today.
- [ ] Weekly call slot that survives tour season, and how fast he needs you between calls.
- [ ] He has a spare Microsoft 365 licence on Music Republik. Take the **musicrepublik.com address**. It is a co-founder signal, not admin.
- [ ] He wants a transcript and has no Teams. Google Meet recording or notes on from the first minute.

Clear up Section 1 — 5 MIN

- [ ] Is **R4m** what lands in his pocket after tax, or is "R4–5m a year" what the business makes?
- [ ] **R1.5m** was per tour. In a whole bad year, what's the most he could lose before it touches home?
- [ ] Days off: **20 or 24**?
- [x] Is **Mushroom Motion** the camera business? **Yes.** Confirmed on WhatsApp 21 Oct, with the website.

What has a deadline

10 MIN

- [ ] **Sixes:** what have they asked for, by when? Do they want his time or name as well as money? Any surety? What's his gut?
- [ ] **Camera / Mushroom Motion:** the ChatGPT plan he sent is a direct-to-brand sales strategy for Willem Schoeman's business, not for him. Is he being pulled into doing their business development for 12% and a retainer? Stay, go silent, or sell the 12%: which feels right today? UPDATED
- [ ] **Virgin Music:** does he want the Gareth Wilson intro now? Which local acts would he lead with?
- [ ] **Anything else with a clock:** venues holding dates, partners waiting on him. He said on 21 Oct he'd "send a few things" on ticketing and nothing followed. Ask.

Walk the projects

30 MIN

Same short questions for each, in plain words. When he hesitates, write "don't know" and move on.

> What is it, in a sentence? · What came in from it this past year, roughly? · Next 12 months, more like ___ or ___? · How much of your week does it eat? · What's stuck? · Do you like doing it?

Start with what his Tuesday is built on. Go quicker on the lines he wants out of.

- [ ] **Own concerts.** UPDATED He gave you the economics on 21 Oct: every agent says "the money doesn't work at this level." The benchmark for two shows has moved from **$250k to $300–350k** for acts like The Kid Laroi, Empire of the Sun and Dominic Fike. Even Daughtry wants $250k against $150k in 2018. A sold-out two-arena run, Grand Arena plus SunBet, makes **R2–2.5m profit**. A **co-promotion partner goes 50/50** on risk and profit. Ask: who is the partner, what is his half of the exposure in rand, which act is first, and what's the best and worst result so far.
- [ ] **Brand-owned events and festivals.** Which brands, and is anything signed? He says brands "want to see you do shows first." Which brand has said that, and what would count as proof?
- [ ] **Ticketing platform.** UPDATED It now has a name, **Fastgate**, and he spoke to his partner on 20 Oct. His logic: own ticketing gives him the sales data and makes the capital "minimal", with Chartmetric backing the show picks. When does it launch? Who builds it, who owns it, what has he put in? First three events it tickets?
- [ ] **Consultancy.** Who's paying or likely to pay?
- [ ] **Merch: touring, local acts, new channels.** One pass for all three. The business is called **Merchhaus** and has its own Microsoft 365 licence. What does a normal tour do, against Travis Scott at R5m? Could the two youngsters run it with him on strategy only?
- [ ] **Camera.** Skip if it was covered under deadlines.

Money at home

5 MIN

- [ ] What the household needs per month, bracketed.
- [ ] How many months he'd be fine if everything stopped paying.
- [ ] Any loans, guarantees or artist advances already signed?

Close

5 MIN

- [ ] Read the "don't know" list back to him. That's the first 90 days.
- [ ] His three things for the first 90 days, in order. Specific beats grand.
- [ ] Confirm the November start and that the invoice is on its way.

Leave for the first session: the two-week time audit.

The "don't know" list

FILL IN AS YOU GO

03 What he gave you in Section 1

Take-home per year	**R4m** after tax
Floor	**R1m**
Days off	Wants **20** (typed) or **24** (voice note). Last 12 months: about **10 days** with the family and young kids. Days to himself: **none in about five years.**
Hours	**50 now, "basically always online."** Year 3: **40**, shut down at 8pm, phone off.
A good week	Gym 2x, daughter drop-off 1x, 30–45 min with the kids after work, dog walk 3x, golf 1x, series at night. Break 5:00–7:30pm, then 1–1.5h more work if he has to, done by 8–8:30. *"I never leave a day with even one unread email, ever."*
Would do even if paid less	Finding artists, listening to music, artist stats, who tours where, booking through agents, tour financial models, festival properties and annual recurring concepts, creative concept work, big brand activations
Off his desk by Christmas	Mushroom Motion admin (WhatsApps, emails he's cc'd on). Music Republik admin (workman's comp and the like). Finance and accounts for MR and Merchhaus. Merchhaus forecasts, ordering and settlements, handed to "the two youngsters." Marketing plan, on-sale process, concept decks, brand-partner outreach. Quotes and lead gen, maybe through a freelance accountant. "A lot of automation."
A Tuesday in 3 years	Gym, breakfast with his wife. A few major annual music events and recurring-revenue projects, a few clients, **4–5 staff max, R4–5m a year.** No merch operations. Out of the camera business and its 12% admin, "unless it really makes sense." 100% his own businesses, with his own ticketing, marketing team and ops person. His job: find artists and opportunities, keep brands happy, put on spectacular shows.
Capital he can lose	"Ideally nothing… I still have my bills to pay." Gave a **per-tour** number: max **R1.5m on one tour**, made up on the next. More than that is "terrible."
Non-negotiables	**The family trust**, which owns 100% of his investment holdco. Nothing gets dragged in: no sureties, and nothing from co-shareholders that reaches the trust.

04 What he sent on 21 October WhatsApp, unprompted

He's in	"Kom ons doen die call en dan kan ons inspring en kan sommer daai betaling doen vir November solank. Kry al die prep werk uit die pad uit." He wants November paid and the prep done.
The crucial problem	"Elke liewe agent sê 'we can't do it at this level, the money doesn't work.'" He needs brand partners or a different angle on concert execution. Brands want to see him do shows first, which means more risk on the guarantee.

The benchmark	$250k for two shows "was altyd so half reg." Now **$300–350k for two shows** for any act with a decent SA following: The Kid Laroi, Empire of the Sun, Dominic Fike. Daughtry wants $250k for two; they got $150k in 2018.
The upside	Sold-out two-show arena run at Grand Arena and SunBet: **R2–2.5m profit.** Co-promotion partner at 50/50 shares risk and profit.
Camera business	Confirmed as **Mushroom Motion**, Willem Schoeman's multicam and live-production company (Johannesburg and Cape Town; credits include Kevin Hart, Travis Scott, Netflix, Volkswagen, Takealot). The ChatGPT link he sent is a direct-to-brand sales plan for Mushroom, signed by Willem.
Ticketing	"Die ticketing besigheid is 'n reality." Partner conversation 20 Oct. Proposed name **Fastgate**. Own ticketing = access to show sales data, and "die capital wat benodig word minimaal, assuming my judgement op shows is reg, geback met stats via Chartmetric." Said he'd send more; nothing came.
Admin	Microsoft 365 licences still live for Music Republik and **Merchhaus**, offered for an email address. Wants a transcript of the call; no Teams.

05 Early read

for you, not for him yet

1. **The overwhelm is the same problem as the "always on."** He couldn't find 45 minutes for a form because everything already lands on him. Nearly every item on his off-desk list is something that pings him. The life-design target is an off-switch at 8pm and a number of phone-off days, more than extra days off.
2. **R4m might mean two very different things.** A take-home of R4m after tax needs about **R7m of pre-tax profit or salary** reaching him. But his Tuesday says the business is "making R4–5m a year." If that's profit, his take-home is closer to **R2.3–2.9m**. Pin this down first, because it roughly doubles or halves the plan.
3. **The risk number is per tour, not per year.** Two bad R1.5m tours in one year means R3m lost, against a R1m floor and "I still have my bills to pay."
4. **The guarantee has outrun his risk budget.** NEW Half of a $300–350k guarantee is well past R1.5m before production costs, even with the 50/50 partner. So the co-promotion alone does not get him inside his own number. Either a third risk partner (brand or venue), a smaller or ascending act where Chartmetric shows SA demand the agent hasn't priced, or one smaller first show that becomes the proof brands ask for. Score each against Section 1 on the call, not against the dream.
5. **His Tuesday is a promoter's life.** That means own concerts, brand-owned annual events and his own ticketing. Merch operations and the camera business are both in his "no more" column. For those lines the question is how he exits or delegates them, not how he grows them.
6. **Mushroom is pulling him in, not out.** NEW The plan he forwarded targets exactly the brand marketing directors who would underwrite a concert. One outreach could carry two products, but only with hours capped and a commission on top of the retainer. Otherwise it's the 12% admin he wants gone by Christmas. His call, made today.
7. **"Minimal capital" means pre-sales fund the guarantee.** NEW That is the classic way promoters go under: ticket money spent on deposits before the show happens. Fastgate is a good instinct for data and

margin; it is not a substitute for a risk budget. Keep it a tool for the concerts line this quarter, not a software company.

8. **Sixes has to pass his own Section 1.** He wants "100% my own businesses" and to stop carrying "admin as a 12% shareholder." Sixes is another minority stake that expects more than money. It only passes if it's money with no time, no name and no surety attached.
9. **Turn the trust non-negotiable into a check.** Have any personal sureties or holdco guarantees already been signed? Look at artist offers, venue deposits, the ticketing partner and the camera business.

Quick win to hand him on the call: get him off the cc list at Mushroom Motion this week.